

THE SOCIAL UNIVERSE (TSU)

Continuity Bible — Master Canon Document

Purpose: This is the single source of truth for TSU canon. Every writer, every script, every "wait, did we already establish X" question gets answered here first. If it's not in this doc, it's not canon yet — propose it, don't assume it. This doc is the Kevin Feige's-office equivalent: nothing ships to a script until it's logged here.

Companion docs: TSU_Platform_Roster.md (fictional platforms) · TSU_Core_Cast.md (founding character bios)

1. THE SERIALIZATION MODEL

Ratio: 70% standalone / 30% serialized, matching the proven MCU structure.

- **The 70%:** Every platform-founding film must work as a complete, self-contained story for an audience who has seen *nothing* else in TSU. No film's core plot may depend on information withheld to a prior film.
 - **The 30%:** Reserved for recurring characters crossing platforms, the through-line antagonist forces (THE ENGINE, THE SWARM, THE LEAK, THE COPIES), fixed timeline anchor-events referenced across films, and stingers/easter eggs seeding future Phases.
 - **Rule of thumb for any new scene:** if removing it would make a *different* film confusing, it's part of the 30% and must be logged in this doc's Cross-Film Threads section before the film locks picture. If removing it only affects the film it's in, it's part of the 70% and doesn't need cross-checking.
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2. FORMAT & HOUSE STYLE

Binding specs for every TSU script. A script that deviates from these numbers needs a sign-off logged in §8, same as any other locked fact.

Genre & Subgenre

Primary genre: **Biographical Drama / Tech Origin Story** — the spine of the whole universe, playing the same structural role "superhero action" plays for the MCU. This is what "100% faithful to source material" actually means in practice: dramatizing real founding myths (fictionalized), not inventing fantasy.

Subgenres layer per-Phase, the way MCU shifts tone film to film, rather than applying uniformly to every entry: - **Corporate thriller** — founder disputes, betrayals, acquisitions (THE ROSTER's origin, the Phase 2 "Quiet Acquisition") - **Underdog sports-movie structure** — borrowed shape (not genre) for Phase 1 founding arcs: scrappy outsider builds something from nothing, takes on giants - **Ensemble dramedy** — the found-family/relationship material (weddings, godparent-hood, group dynamics) that can't live inside corporate-thriller tension alone - **Satire, dialed carefully** — reserved specifically for THE SWARM and

THE ENGINE storylines; TSU's comic-relief valve, same job Ant-Man/Guardians plays tonally inside a heavier universe - **Legal/courtroom drama** — recurring beat for THE LEAK scandals and founder-dispute litigation, same way MCU periodically drops into "Congressional hearing" mode

Rating

PG-13 across the entire universe. No exceptions, no R-rated entries, no PG entries. This is a commercial mechanism, not just a tone choice — PG-13 is the only rating that plays to teens, parents, and adults simultaneously, which is the actual revenue engine of a tentpole franchise. It's also the only rating built to handle betrayal, addiction-adjacent tech-culture critique, and corporate ruthlessness honestly without capping the audience or killing merchandising.

Runtime

Entry Type	Runtime
Standard platform-origin film	130–150 minutes
Phase finale / ensemble crossover	150–180 minutes

Script Page Count (*Industry standard: 1 page is about 1 minute of screen time*)

Entry Type	Page Count
Standard platform-origin film	120–140 pages
Phase finale / ensemble crossover	150–170 pages (hard ceiling — scripts that balloon past this cut in the edit anyway; write tight rather than shoot pages you'll lose)

Act Structure

Three acts, always. - **Act I** — ~25% of runtime (~30–35 pages): ordinary world, inciting incident (the spark for the platform), ends on the decision to build it - **Act II** — ~50% (~65–75 pages): the build, the complications, relationship strain, midpoint escalation (usually a rival platform or a betrayal), ends on the low point / all-is-lost beat - **Act III** — ~25% (~30–35 pages): climax (usually the platform's public launch or direct confrontation with a rival/villain force), resolution, stinger

Scene Count

Entry Type	Scene Count
Standard platform-origin film	~40–55 scenes
Phase finale / ensemble crossover	~55–70 scenes (larger ensemble needs more coverage)

3. FIXED TIMELINE ANCHORS

Dates and events every film must treat as immovable fact. Individual films may show these events from a new angle but may never contradict them.

Anchor Event	Date	What It Locks
THE LEDGER founded	1997	Phase 0 opens
HOMESTEAD shutdown ("The First Erasure")	2001	TSU's first mass-casualty event — referenced as cultural trauma in later Phases
THE FIRST CIRCLE launches	2002	Phase 1 begins
TOP8 launches	2003	—
THE BOARDROOM launches	2003	—
THE ROSTER launches	Feb 2004	Founding-four complete
Phase 1 Finale — "The Feed War"	2004–2005	THE ROSTER absorbs/outlasts TOP8. First platform-vs-platform casualty event.
THE PROJECTOR launches	2005	Phase 2 begins
THE HIVE launches	2005	—
THE WIRE launches	2006	—
THE GALLERY launches	2007	—
THE FRAME launches	2010	Phase 2 closes
Phase 2 Finale — "The Quiet Acquisition"	2010–2012	THE ROSTER acquires THE FRAME
THE WHISPER NETWORK launches	2009	Phase 3 begins (chronological overlap w/ Phase 2 is intentional — see §5)
THE ATLAS launches	2010	—
THE EMBER launches	2011	—
THE FLICKER launches	2013	—

Anchor Event	Date	What It Locks
"The Flicker Goes Dark"	2016	THE FLICKER shuts down. TSU's mass-mourning event. Diaspora subplot begins.
THE OUTPOST launches	2015	Phase 3 closes
THE ORACLE launches	2018	Phase 4 begins
THE MIRROR launches	2020	—
THE ECHO launches	2023	—
SIGNAL-0 (THE WIRE reborn)	2023	Phase 4 current state

Standing rule: no future script may move a launch date without a change-request logged in §8 and approved before the page is written. A launch date is load-bearing — other films' timelines are built off it.

4. CHARACTER LOCATION / STATUS TRACKER

Where each founding cast member is, professionally, at the start and end of each Phase. Update this table the moment any film changes a character's status — this is the most common source of continuity errors in ensemble franchises (an actor's film shoots out of release order, and a character's status quo gets contradicted by accident).

Character	Status, Start of Phase 1 (2002)	Status, End of Phase 1 (2004–05)	Notes
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Working actor/singer, pre-adult-breakout	Founder/CEO, THE ROSTER; survived the Feed War's opening attack, a managed arrhythmia, and a public reckoning with Solomon Kane's claim against Victor Donohue	Locked per <code>scripts/THE_ROSTER.md</code> and <code>scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md</code> . Public triumph, personal cost — closes Phase 1 estranged from Amond, leaning on Esther and Tyrese instead
Amond Baker	Typecast, cooling career	Co-founder, THE ROSTER — diluted out via cap-table restructure; estranged from Marc-Anthony	Locked per <code>scripts/THE_ROSTER.md</code> . This wound is the direct inciting wound for his own founding story, Film 2/Phase 2 (see §9)

Character	Status, Start of Phase 1 (2002)	Status, End of Phase 1 (2004–05)	Notes
Tyrese Avery	Established global pop superstar	Founder, THE PROJECTOR (launched, then lost, then rebuilt smaller in Dec 2005)	Locked per <code>scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md</code> . New relationship (Dr. Simone Kester) originates here — first romantic arc for this character
Esther Smilley	Award-winning actress, fighting "sweetheart" typecasting	<i>(platform assignment pending)</i>	Not yet romantically involved w/ Marc-Anthony — that doesn't begin until 2011, no film may imply earlier
Arianna Cummings	Three professional near-misses, no breakthrough	Founder, THE FRAME (launched Oct 25, 2010, from a hospital waiting room during her brother's recovery)	Locked per <code>scripts/THE_FRAME.md</code> . New relationship (Malcolm Pierce) originates here
Harmony Divine	Dancer transitioning to acting	<i>(platform assignment pending)</i>	Not yet romantically involved w/ Amond — begins 2013
Tyler Chapman	Steady "and also starring" work, capped ceiling	<i>(platform assignment pending)</i>	Secret music ambition is a Chekhov's gun — a later Phase should pay it off

Locked romantic timeline (do not contradict in any script, flashback, or flash-forward): - Marc-Anthony & Esther: friends throughout Phase 1–2, together 2011, married 2013 - Amond & Harmony: circling throughout Phase 1–3, together 2013, married 2015 - Emma & Victoria Bullock born May 10, 2012 (twins) - Lyric Baker born April 20, 2014; Marc-Anthony is godfather

5. THE VILLAINS BENCH — RULES OF ENGAGEMENT

Because THE ENGINE, THE LEAK, THE SWARM, and THE COPIES are forces rather than single actors/characters, they need usage rules so they don't become a crutch:

- **THE ENGINE** may appear inside any platform's internal story, but must manifest differently each time (it's not one villain wearing different masks — it's a recurring *idea*, re-cast in tone and visual language per platform). THE ENGINE inside THE ROSTER should not look or feel like THE ENGINE inside THE ORACLE.
- **THE LEAK** is a one-per-Phase maximum event. Overusing it flattens its impact — it should land like a real scandal, not a plot device you can pull twice a Phase.

- **THE SWARM** is the only bench villain allowed genuine comic relief — a trickster figure that should never be played as a pure threat.
- **THE COPIES** exist to signal a platform's decline is coming, never to be the actual reason a platform falls. The real cause of any platform's fall must always trace back to a character decision, per the "faithful to source material" mandate — these platforms died from human choices (acquisitions, mismanagement, neglect), not from an abstract force acting alone.

6. KNOWN TIMELINE OVERLAP (INTENTIONAL, NOT AN ERROR)

Phases are organized thematically, not strictly chronologically — same approach MCU uses (Captain Marvel is set in the 90s but released in Phase 3). THE WHISPER NETWORK (2009) launches before THE FRAME (2010) closes out Phase 2. This is intentional: Phase boundaries mark thematic shifts (Media Wars -> Mobile Saga), not hard calendar cutoffs. Any writer confused by an out-of-phase date should check this section before "fixing" it.

7. OPEN CONTINUITY QUESTIONS

(Must be resolved before Phase 1 scripts lock)

1. **Platform assignments** — which founder gets which platform. Nothing in §3 can be finalized until this is settled.

Locked constraint (user directive): the core seven are founders of the major platforms that are **still popular and around to this day** — i.e., surviving/thriving platforms as of present day, not defunct ones. This rules out assigning any of the core seven as founders of platforms already marked dead on the Platform Roster (THE LEDGER, ROLL CALL, DEAR DIARY, HOMESTEAD, THE FIRST CIRCLE, TOP8, THE FLICKER) — those stay populated by Rivals/Extended Ensemble characters instead. Which specific surviving platforms (candidates per the Roster: THE ROSTER, THE PROJECTOR, THE FRAME, THE HIVE, THE WIRE/SIGNAL-0, THE ORACLE, THE OUTPOST, THE WHISPER NETWORK, THE BOARDROOM, THE ATLAS, THE EMBER) map to which of the seven is **explicitly not decided yet** — do not assign in any script or scene until this is resolved and logged here.

Resolved so far: - **THE ROSTER** -> **Marc-Anthony Bullock** (founder) + **Amond Baker** (co-founder, diluted out). Locked per `scripts/THE_ROSTER.md`, Film 1 ("Iron Man" slot). - **THE WIRE** -> **Amond Baker** (sole founder, post-ROSTER). Locked as of this entry, Film 2 ("Incredible Hulk" slot) — see §9. Script not yet written. - **THE BOARDROOM** -> **no core-seven founder**. Per `scripts/THE_ROSTER.md` scene 13, it's already a mature "old guard" institution before Phase 1's story begins. It stays that way unless a future pass decides otherwise. - **THE PROJECTOR** -> **Tyrese Avery** (sole founder). Locked, Film 4 ("Thor" release slot) — see §9. Script: `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md`. - **THE FRAME** -> **Arianna Cummings** (sole founder). Locked, Film 5 ("Captain America: The First Avenger" release slot) — see §9. Script: `scripts/THE_FRAME.md`. The reservation flagged when THE PROJECTOR was locked has now been claimed correctly, not spent on a different film. - Remaining unassigned: Esther Smiley, Harmony Divine, Tyler Chapman — and remaining unassigned surviving platforms: THE HIVE, THE ORACLE,

THE OUTPOST, THE WHISPER NETWORK, THE ATLAS, THE EMBER. 2. Does Marc-Anthony's dynasty family (Natasha, Robert, Victor, Joan) have their own platform ties, or do they stay industry-only and never cross into TSU's tech side? 3. Is Tyrese's "outside perspective" going to culminate in him founding a platform himself (likely music/audio-coded, e.g. a Clubhouse-style entry in Phase 4), or does he stay permanently adjacent as a non-founder? 4. Does Tyler's music ambition get its own founding story later, or does it stay a personal subplot inside whichever platform story he's attached to? 5. Confirm whether the "lost a role to follower count" beat for Arianna is meant to happen at a specific, nameable point on the timeline (needs a year) so it can be logged as an anchor event.

8. CHANGE LOG

(Every edit to a locked fact gets logged here, with date and reason — never silently overwrite an established fact)

Date	Change	Reason
—	Doc created	Baseline canon established from Platform Roster + Core Cast docs
—	Added §2 Format & House Style (genre, rating, runtime, page count, act/scene structure); renumbered §3–§8	Locked universal format specs so all future scripts conform
2026-09-17	Added platform-assignment constraint to §7 Q1: the core seven must be founders of platforms still popular/surviving today, not defunct ones. Specific mapping still undecided.	User directive — narrows the open question without resolving it
2026-09-17	Locked Film 1 (THE ROSTER, Marc-Anthony + Amond) and Film 2 (THE WIRE, Amond solo) in §7 Q1 and new §9. Updated §4 tracker for Marc-Anthony and Amond accordingly. Confirmed THE BOARDROOM has no core-seven founder.	Script written for Film 1 (<code>scripts/THE_ROSTER.md</code>); Film 2 platform selected per user request, filling the "Incredible Hulk" release slot
2026-09-17	Standing rule added: a "what's the perfect platform" question is now always a cue to write the full script, not just select the platform. Locked Film 2's script (<code>scripts/THE_WIRE.md</code>).	User directive

Date	Change	Reason
2026-09-17	Locked Film 3: THE ROSTER 2 ("Iron Man 2" slot), dramatizing the Feed War's opening act. Added Eldridge Kane, Solomon Kane, and Carter Westbrook to TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md and TSU_Historical_Context.md §5. Updated §4 tracker for Marc-Anthony.	Script written per user request (scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md)
2026-09-18	Split the Donohue Estate from the Bullock Estate as separate residences; fixed three Victor's-study sluglines in scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md accordingly.	User correction
2026-09-18	Locked Film 4: THE PROJECTOR ("Thor" slot), founded by Tyrese Avery. Added Jamal Kester and Dr. Simone Kester to TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md. Flagged THE FRAME as reserved for the eventual "Captain America" slot rather than assigning it casually. Updated §4 tracker for Tyrese.	Script written per user request (scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md)
2026-09-18	Locked Film 5: THE FRAME ("Captain America: The First Avenger" slot), founded by Arianna Cummings, claiming the reservation flagged in Film 4. Added Celeste Marlowe and Malcolm Pierce to TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md; activated Dr. Adaeze Okonkwo-Brennan and Delphine Okonkwo-Ash on-screen for the first time. Added Arianna's first locked relationship to TSU_Core_Cast.md. Updated §4 tracker for Arianna.	Script written per user request (scripts/THE_FRAME.md)

Doc status: Living document. This is the canon authority — if another doc ever conflicts with this one, this one wins until a change is logged in §8.

9. FILM RELEASE ORDER — MCU-SLOT MAPPING

Tracks which TSU film fills which MCU-analog release slot — a separate axis from the in-universe Phase timeline in §3. A film's release slot and its in-universe Phase do not have to match (exactly as *Iron Man*, Phase 1 slot 1, and *The Incredible Hulk*, Phase 1 slot 2, both released before *Captain Marvel* told a 1990s story in Phase 3).

Release Slot	MCU Analog	TSU Platform	Founder(s)	In-Universe Timeline	Status
Film 1	Iron Man	THE ROSTER	Marc-Anthony Bullock (founder), Amond Baker (co-founder, diluted out)	Sept 2003 – Feb 4, 2004	Locked — see scripts/THE_ROSTER.md
Film 2	The Incredible Hulk	THE WIRE	Amond Baker (sole founder)	March 2005 – March 21, 2006 (launch, fixed anchor per §3)	Locked — see scripts/THE_WIRE.md
Film 3	Iron Man 2	THE ROSTER (again — dramatizes the opening act of the "Feed War" anchor, §3)	Marc-Anthony Bullock, solo (Amond absent — concurrent with his isolation period at the start of Film 2)	April 2004 – Jan 5, 2005	Locked — see scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md
Film 4	Thor	THE PROJECTOR	Tyrese Avery, solo	April 2005 – Dec 2005 (launch anchor 2005 per §3)	Locked — see scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.m
Film 5	Captain America: The First Avenger	THE FRAME	Arianna Cummings, solo	Jan 2009 – Oct 25, 2010 (launch anchor 2010 per §3)	Locked — see scripts/THE_FRAME.md

Note on Film 3: dramatizes only the *opening* of the Feed War (TOP8 wounded, not finished) — the full ensemble payoff of that anchor is deliberately reserved for a later Phase 1 finale film, per house style §2's separate "Phase finale / ensemble crossover" spec, which Film 3 does not use. Film 3 also runs concurrent with the first few weeks of Film 2 (Amond is already isolating in Atlanta throughout Film 3 and does not appear onscreen in it).

Why THE FRAME for Film 5: THE FRAME was flagged as reserved for the Captain America slot back when THE PROJECTOR was locked (Film 4), because it already carried that framing in the Platform Roster before any release-slot planning began. Arianna Cummings is the only remaining core-seven

member whose origin wound was locked as *mandatory to dramatize* (§4) — a person told, repeatedly, by every gatekeeper that she lacks the superficial thing they're measuring, until someone finally sees what's real underneath. This film deliberately does not repeat the co-founder-betrayal structure used twice already (Films 1 and, by extension, 2) — Cap's antagonist is external, not a best friend, so Malcolm Pierce fills the Peggy Carter position (a new, unlocked relationship, same pattern as Tyrese/Simone) rather than a co-founder role, and Desmond Cummings Jr. (already locked as a firefighter in the Family Bible) fills the Bucky position without requiring any retcon.

Why THE PROJECTOR for Film 4: Tyrese Avery is the only core-seven member already famous on his own axis before Phase 1 even opens, and his Core Cast bio never locked a romantic partner the way the other six did — both facts made him the cleanest available Thor: inherited greatness, an arrogance that costs him everything, banishment to an ordinary world, and a new relationship (Dr. Simone Kester) this film originates rather than works around. Reverend Earl Avery fills the Odin position using material already on the books; Jeri Avery deliberately stays loyal throughout rather than becoming a Loki, preserving his locked bible entry instead of retconning it for drama.

Why THE WIRE for Film 2: Twitter/X's real cultural identity — fast, addictive, real-time, structurally incapable of nuance, capable of turning a normal person into a viral mob target before anyone can process what happened — is TSU's cleanest available "you wouldn't like me when I'm angry" analog. Amond Baker, walking away from THE ROSTER quietly furious and permanently under-credited, builds a platform meant to give people an unfiltered, unmediated voice — the opposite of being diluted and silenced — and it grows into something with real, uncontrollable power to destroy a person's reputation overnight, power even its own founder fears and can't fully leash. That's Bruce Banner's arc structurally: the guarded, controlled one builds (releases) something out of his own wound that becomes bigger, angrier, and more dangerous than he intended. It also lets Film 2 pay off Film 1's ending directly, satisfying the Continuity Bible's 30%-serialized cross-film thread rule (§1) without requiring the audience to have seen Film 1 to follow Film 2's own self-contained story (per the 70% rule).